

Microsoft adds PowerShell Core to its own repository

Microsoft has just launched PowerShell Core 6.0 alpha on its own Packages repository. All the PowerShell Core releases were previously published on the GitHub repository, but the new change has made its installation much easier. However, the company will continue to support both GitHub and its own repository in the future.

To install the latest PowerShell Core alpha version, you need to register on Microsoft's repository as a super-user. You can update and install the framework using a terminal command after gaining super-user access.

Depending upon the Linux distribution, you need to run the 'sudo apt-get install powershell' or 'sudo yum update powershell' command to update the PowerShell Core package on your system.



It seems that Microsoft is taking extra efforts to improve the experience of PowerShell on Linux. The Redmond company wants to work closely with the community to enhance the experience. Additionally, it is seeking feedback and suggestions from the open source community to improve its approach for PowerShell Core.

Years after its exclusive availability on the Windows platform, Microsoft brought PowerShell to the Linux world last August. The task automation and configuration management framework has been made available as an open source project by the software giant and is compatible with a wide range of Linux distributions such as CentOS, Red Hat Enterprise Linux and Ubuntu.

LibreOffice Online uses the 'core engine' of the open source package. Though it was initially considered as an alternative to Google Docs, the Web package comes as a server service, and needs to be installed and configured manually by adding cloud storage and an SSL certificate. Nevertheless, the online version could help enterprises and large organisations with the public cloud or private cloud technologies. Apart from the cloud-focused release, LibreOffice 5.3 includes the new cross-platform text layout engine. This new offering uses HarfBuzz to deliver a consistent text layout across all platforms. The Document Foundation has additionally provided improvements across languages and alphabets as well as offered a revised *Help* menu with quick links to user guides and community support forums. The updated LibreOffice also comes with improved versions of Writer, Calc and Impress.

The refined Writer has table styling support, enabling users to apply formatting to tables in the document and has a page deck in the sidebar to simplify page setting customisations. It also comes with a new *Go to Page* box to let you jump to another page in the document with just a few keystrokes.

Calc, on the other hand, now has a new set of default cell styles and includes a text entry box to simplify the search for various functions. In a fresh installation, you will notice 'Enable wildcards in formulas' as the default option to improve compatibility with other spreadsheet software like Microsoft Excel.

The new LibreOffice has also added a template selector in Impress to give you a quick-start experience. Besides, there is a new Slide Properties Deck available in the sidebar during slide master mode.

LibreOffice has attracted more than 1,100 new developers. Michael Meeks of the Document Foundation claimed that, in just the last two years, an average of 300 new people have got active on the source code. "LibreOffice is backed by a fantastic community of developers," Meeks said in a statement. LibreOffice 5.3 is available for free download on its official website. Enterprise deployments can work best on the more mature 5.2.5 version.

Google Chrome on iOS now gets open sourced

After several years of efforts, Google has finally open sourced its Chrome on iOS. The latest development has brought the open source Web browser code to the Chromium project to let developers modify it, just like they can for any of its other versions.

As Apple's iOS is quite conservative when it comes to open source developments, the code for Chrome on iOS was not kept with the rest of the Chromium project until now.

Google also added WebKit support alongside its Blink rendering engine to match the guidelines of iOS. However, all that brought about some 'extra complexities' that would be resolved with the open source version.

"Given Chrome's commitment to open source code, we have spent a lot of time over the past several years making the changes required to upstream the code for Chrome for iOS into Chromium," Google's upstream angler Rohit Rao wrote in a blog post. Google considers that bringing Chrome for iOS to the open source community will increase its development speed. Since all the tests for the browser are available to the Chromium project, they can automatically run on the Chrome for iOS code base with a single execution.

You can access the iOS code from the Chromium repository to compile the newest open source offering. This could help you advance your next Web project.

For more news, visit www.opensourceforu.com

